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UKRAINE POLITICAL SYSTEM

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Introduction:

Ukraine[1], country located in Eastern Europe, the second largest on the continent after Russia and its capital is Kyiv. It is one of the countries of strategic importance in the world, thanks to its vital geographical location linking Eastern Europe and Western Europe. Ukraine has rich natural resources, including fertile farmland that ranks among the most productive globally, making it one of the largest exporters of grains and vegetable oils .Furthermore, Ukraine is an energy hub, with natural gas pipelines that transport fuel from Russia to Europe running through it, making it a major player in European energy security. Politically, Ukraine represents a point of intersection between Western powers and Russia, giving it a pivotal role in international geopolitical issues.

Environment of the Political system:

1-Geography of Ukraine:

Ukraine covers an area of 233,088 square miles (603,700 km2), slightly larger than France[2],Ukraine is located in Eastern Europe and has borders with the Russian Federation, Moldova, Romania, Hungary, Slovakia, Poland and Belarus. It also has an extensive coastline bordering the Black Sea. Large areas of the country are almost flat, making up the steppe north of the Black Sea. The steppe is underlain by fertile black

[1] Yerofeyev, I. Alekseyevich, Zasenko, Oleksa Eliseyovich, Makuch, Andrij, Stebelsky, Ihor, Hajda, Lubomyr A. and Kryzhanivsky, Stepan Andriyovich. "Ukraine." Encyclopedia Britannica, December 11, 2024. https://www.britannica.com/place/Ukraine.

[2] COUNTRY REPORTS. "Ukraine Geography." Accessed [n.d.].https://www.countryreports.org/country/Ukraine/geography.htm.

soil. Mountains are found in the west (Carpathian Mountains). The Crimean Peninsula located on the Black Sea to the south is also mountainous. The Dnieper River divides the country from north to south. The Donetz River drains the eastern part. The Donetz Basin is an important industrial area with deposits of hard coal. The coal is found together with iron ore[3].

2- Society and Demographic Features:

According to the Constitution of Ukraine, Ukrainian is the primary language of the country, and the population of Ukraine is made up of various nationalities. Besides Ukrainian, several other languages are used by national minorities Romanian, Hungarian, Bulgarian, Polish and Russian, the most popular languages in English, German and French after the primary language, later English was adopted as the official language through international communication.

Ukraine has a variety of religions, but Christianity is predominant, with 97% of the existing denominations. There are religions such as Islam, Buddhism and Hinduism, and multiple denominations such as Protestantism and Catholicism[4].

Ukraine has experienced a remarkable change in its population in recent decades. After the fall of the Soviet Union in 1991 it had a population of about 50 million, which is close to the average population of the East Central Asian countries, but by 2021 it

[3] UKRAINE. "Geography Geology." IAEA INFCIS. Accessed [n.d.].https://infcis.iaea.org/udepo/Resources/Countries/Ukraine.pdf.

[4] European Commission. Eurydice. "Ukraine: Last Update, 17 September 2024." https://eurydice.eacea.ec.europa.eu/national-education-systems/ukraine/population-demographic-situation-languages-and-religion

had reached about 40 million. The population is declining due to its war with Russia and the emigration of 6.7 million people who left Ukraine. Death due to the war has risen, but the number of deaths has varied[5].

3- Historical Development of Ukraine (The most important historical political events in Ukraine from 1991 to 2022):

Ukraine was born in 1991 when President Leonid Kraft-Schuuk declared its secession from the Soviet Union, gaining an overwhelming majority, and in 1994 Leonid Kuchma gave up the world's largest nuclear Arsenal in exchange for independence in a memorandum between Russia, the United States, and Britain.

In 2004, President Viktor Bankovic took over as president of Russia, in 2005 President Viktor Yushchenko took over as president, in 2010 Yanukovych took office, and a port on the Black Sea of Crimea was leased to the Russian fleet, in 2013 partnership with the European Union was suspended, and in 2014 violent protests centered largely around Kiev Independence Square. Dozens of protesters were killed, and the Ukrainian parliament voted in February to dismiss Yanukovich, who had fled the country. Within days, gunmen took control of the Crimean parliament and raised the Russian flag. Moscow annexed the region after a referendum on March 16, 2014, which showed overwhelming support from Crimean residents to join Russia.

In 2021 Zelinsky appealed to US President Joe Biden in January that Ukraine be allowed to join NATO. In December 2021 Russia made detailed security claims that

[5] Euro News. "Demographic Crisis in Ukraine: Population Declines by About 10 Million Since War." Published October 23, 2024.https://arabic.euronews.com/2024/10/23/ukraines-population-has-declined-by-10-million-since-the-war.

included a legally binding guarantee that NATO would cease any military activity in Eastern Europe and Ukraine. Putin declared war on Ukraine. In his 21 February 2022 speech, Putin said Ukraine was an integral part of Russian history[6].

Political Institutions in Ukraine:

There are many political institutions in Ukraine, but the most important political institutions in this context would be:

1. The President
2. The Verkhovna Rada (Parliament)
3. The Cabinet of Ministries
4. The Constitutional Court
5. The Supreme Court

While the constitution of Ukraine is a cornerstone of the nation's political and legal system, it isn't always a lively entity or company concerned in governance. Instead, it's rather far the superb legal framework that defines the structure, powers, and features of political institutions. Its function is foundational, serving as the blueprint for the functioning of bodies like the presidency, parliament, judiciary, and executive agencies.

[6] Reuters, Alabama News Paper. "Ukraine's Turbulent History from Independence to the Russian Invasion." Published August 26, 2022. https://www.alanba.com.kw/1137613.

Discussing the Constitution as an organization could conflate its legal and normative nature with the operational roles of governance structure.

The President of Ukraine:

The President of Ukraine is the head of the state and represents the country domestically and internationally. The president acts as the guarantor of state sovereignty, territorial integrity, adherence to the constitution, and the protection of the rights and freedoms of individuals.

The president is elected for a five-year term through direct, equal, and secret voting by citizens of Ukraine. Eligibility includes being at least 35 years old, a Ukrainian citizen, residing in Ukraine for the last ten years before the election, and fluent in the official language.[7]

The president enjoys legal immunity during their term of office, and the title of the title of president is retained for life unless removed by impeachment. The president's powers may end prematurely due to resignation, inability to preform duties due to health, impeachment, or death. Procedures for the Constitution.[8]

The Verkhovna Rada (Parliament):

The Verkhovna Rada is Ukraine's unicameral parliament or its sole legislative body, responsible for enacting laws and exercising other constitutional powers. It is central to

[7] The constitution of Ukraine. Kyiv: Vekhovna Rada of Ukraine, 1996. https://www.justice.gov/sites/default/files/legacy/2013/11/08/constitution_14.pdf , arts. 102-103.

[8] The constitution of Ukraine. Kyiv: Vekhovna Rada of Ukraine, 1996. https://www.justice.gov/sites/default/files/legacy/2013/11/08/constitution_14.pdf , arts. 105-106.

the country's governance, with the authority to make laws, approve budgets, oversee the executive branch, and ratify international agreements. The Rada operates under a proportional representation system, with members elected for five year terms.

The Verkhovana Rada is about 450 deputies, elected through direct, secret, and equal voting. Deputies must be Ukrainian citizen at least 21 years old, have voting rights, and have resided in Ukraine for the last five years.[9]

The powers of the Verkhovna Rada include adopting laws, approving the budget, determining domestic and foreign policies, scheduling elections, approving government programs, ratifying international treaties, and overseeing executive actions, it also can initiate impeachment proceedings against the president under specific circumstances.[10]

The Cabinet of Ministers:

The cabinet of Ministers in Ukraine preforms a frequently subordinate function whithinside the semi-presidential framework. While the charter officially concentrates government features whithinside the President dominates coverage initiation and decision-making processes. The cabinet's function is basically limited to imposing presidential directives and supplying expertise, instead of independently shaping overseas or home policies.

[9] The constitution of Ukraine. Kyiv: Vekhovna Rada of Ukraine, 1996.

https://www.justice.gov/sites/default/files/legacy/2013/11/08/constitution_14.pdf , art. 76.

[10]The constitution of Ukraine. Kyiv: Vekhovna Rada of Ukraine, 1996.

https://www.justice.gov/sites/default/files/legacy/2013/11/08/constitution_14.pdf , art. 85.

The Cabinet basically have main features, and these features include:

1. Subordination to the presidency: the Ukrainian president exerts full size have an impact on over the Cabinet, frequently overshadowing its coverage-making function.

This dominance is facilitated via way of means of the president's decree powers, which regularly function the muse for Cabinet actions.

2. Instability and Political Weakness: The cabinet has skilled excessive turnover rates, with a mean time period of 13.5 months all through the post-communist decade. Cabinets are frequently technocratic instead of political cohesive, decided on frequently for loyalty to the president and technical expertise.

3. Limited Legislative Role: the cabinet lacks a sturdy connection to the parliament, main to susceptible legislative coordination. This separation slows down coverage system and implementation, in particular regions requiring legislative approval or support.[11]

The Constitutional Court:

The constitutional court of Ukraine holds a pivotal position in deciphering and safeguarding the constitution, in particular with inside the context of a semi-presidential system. Its mandate consists of resolving disputes concerning the constitutionality of legal guidelines and acts, imparting interpretations of constitutional provisions, and addressing conflicts amongst branches of presidency. However, it position is fashioned

[11] Protsky, Oleh. "Domestic Political Institutions in Ukraine and Russia and Their Responses to EU enlargement". Communist and Post Communist Studies 36, no. 4 (2003): 427-442. University of California Press. https://www.jstor.org/stable/10.2307/48609477.

through institutional and political dynamics that every now and then restrict its independence and efficacy.

The Court has its role in judicial review, in which the Constitutional Court is entrusted with the authority to check legal guidelines, decrees, and different legislative or government acts for his or her compliance with the constitution. This position making it as a key arbiter in preserving constitutional order and stability amongst state institutions.

The Court also acts in Conflict Resolution, the Court often intervenes in disputes among the legislative and government branches that are inherent in Ukraine's semi-presidential system. Such disputes regularly stand up from competing political legitimacies and overlapping responsibilities, in particular concerning the department of powers among the president and parliament.[12]

The Supreme Court of Ukraine:

The Ukrainian Supreme Court, is the very highest judicial authority withinside the preferred jurisdiction system of Ukraine. Established through the reforms enacted by the judiciary act of 2016, it was restructured and began operating under its new form in December 2017. The Supreme Court oversees four cessation court: Civil, criminal, administrative, and commercial, as well as the grand chamber. These divisions ensure specialization and efficiency in handling appeals from lower courts.

[12] Constitutional Court of Ukraine. "About the Court". 2024, constitutional court of Ukraine 2024. Accessed on December 10. https://ccu.gov.ua/en/storinka/information-about-court ,

https://ccu.gov.ua/en/storinka/legal/acts

The court's transformation from the previous "Supreme Court of Ukraine" to simply the "Supreme Court" was part of broader judicial reforms aimed towards growing independence, transparency, and expert standards. The adjustments have been additionally supposed to align the judiciary greater carefully with European standards, aspirations for European integration.[13]

The Party system in Ukraine:

Ukraine's political system is characterized by a fragmented and evolving multi-party structure. Political parties often rise and fall with electoral cycles, influenced by the country's shifting geopolitical, economic, and social challenges. Below is an in-depth look at the major political parties and their platforms:

First Pro-European parties:

Pro-European parties in Ukraine gained momentum after the 2014 Euromaidan protests, which were sparked by former President Viktor Yanukovych's decision to suspend an EU Association Agreement in favor of closer ties with Russia. The protests led to Yanukovych's removal and a dramatic shift in Ukraine's political orientation toward the West. This shift was solidified by subsequent Russian aggression, including

[13] Antsupova, Tetyana. "Judiciary in Ukraine: Evolution through System Deficiencies and Everlasting Reforms". British Institute of International and comparative law, The British Academy. London, 2022, July 2023. Accessed on December 10.
https://www.biicl.org/documents/11895_judiciary_in_ukraine_prof.pdf

the annexation of Crimea and the war in the Donbas region, which further galvanized support for pro-European parties[14].

Pro-European forces have played a critical role in passing key legislation to align Ukraine with EU norms, such as judicial reforms, anti-corruption initiatives, and measures to improve human rights and governance and for details to the major

Parties in it:

1-European Solidarity

One of the most prominent pro-European parties is European Solidarity, led by former President Petro Poroshenko.The party champions Ukraine's integration into the EU and NATO as a cornerstone of its policy. It gained prominence during Poroshenko's presidency (2014–2019), a period marked by significant geopolitical challenges, including the annexation of Crimea and the war in the Donbas region. European Solidarity emphasizes national defense, advocating for military modernization and strong international alliances.

The party has been a vocal opponent of Russian influence and aggression. Under Poroshenko's leadership, Ukraine signed the Association Agreement with the EU, strengthening economic and political ties. European Solidarity also supports judicial

[14] Petro Borysenko, European Integration in Ukrainian Politics (Kyiv: Lviv Academic Press, 2020), 34-38.

and anti-corruption reforms as part of the broader effort to align Ukraine with European standards[15].

2- Servant of the People

While not initially founded as an explicitly pro-European party, Servant of the People, led by President Volodymyr Zelensky, has adopted a clear pro-European stance during its tenure. The party's policies focus on strengthening ties with the EU and NATO, particularly in the context of Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022. Zelensky's leadership has positioned Ukraine as a key partner to Europe, seeking accelerated EU membership and substantial Western military and financial support. The party's focus on digital transformation and economic liberalization aligns with broader European objectives[16].

Second Pro-Russian parties:

It's historically advocated for closer ties with Russia, often aligning with the views of pro-Russian communities, particularly in eastern and southern regions of the country. These parties have promoted policies that favor Russia politically, economically, and culturally, while resisting Ukraine's integration into Western institutions like NATO and the European Union. However, the role of these parties has become more contentious following Russia's annexation of Crimea in 2014 and the ongoing conflict

[15] Iryna Solonenko, "The Dynamics of Pro-European Movements in Ukraine," Journal of Ukrainian Studies 24, no. 2 (2017): 215-223.

[16] Dominique Arel, "Ukraine's European Choice: Pro-European Movements in Context," East European Politics and Societies 31, no. 4 (2019): 921-932.

in Eastern Ukraine[17], which deeply polarized the political landscape and the most significant parties were:

1-Opposition Platform – For Life (OPFL):

It's a major political force until its activities were officially banned in 2022 due to the ongoing war. Formed in 2018, the OPFL emerged as a merger of several pro-Russian factions, most notably the Party of Regions, which was closely aligned with the presidency of Viktor Yanukovych, the pro-Russian president ousted during the 2014 Euromaidan protests. The OPFL positioned itself as the primary voice of the Russian-speaking population, calling for greater autonomy for regions in eastern Ukraine, and strongly opposed Ukraine's European integration, particularly NATO membership, it was known for its opposition to the government's pro-European stance, advocating instead for the continuation of economic and political ties with Russia[18].

2- The Communist Party of Ukraine (CPU):

It has been banned several times, including after the 2014 annexation of Crimea. The CPU has historically supported closer relations with Russia, advocating for the restoration of ties to the Soviet Union and its policies of economic collectivism. The party's influence began to wane after Ukraine gained independence in 1991, but it remained a vocal proponent of pro-Russian sentiment, especially during times of heightened tensions with the West.

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[17] Taras Kuzio, "The Decline of Pro-Russian Parties in Ukraine: Post-Maidan Politics," Problems of Post-Communism 63, no. 3 (2016): 132-136.

[18] Andreas Umland, "The Marginalization of Pro-Russian Political Groups in Ukraine," Ukrainian Political Review 12, no. 2 (2018): 88-91.

Before its ban, the CPU had often aligned itself with Russia on many geopolitical issues, including its stance on NATO and EU expansion, which it viewed as a threat to Russian influence in the post-Soviet space. In the period before the 2014 revolution, the party also supported the Russian-backed Viktor Yanukovych government and his decision to suspend the EU Association Agreement, which triggered the Euromaidan protests[19].

Ukraine Electoral System: mixed electoral system

Ukraine's elections are a critical component of its democratic processes, cause of it‘s political and social history, Ukraine conducts two primary types of national elections: presidential and parliamentary. Presidential elections occur every five years through a **two-round voting system**. If no candidate secures more than 50% of the vote in the first round, the top two candidates proceed to a run off[20].

Ukraine uses a mixed electoral system for parliamentary electionsThese elections are conducted every **five years**, with half (225) of the parliamentary seats (450) filled through proportional representation and the other half through single-member districts. This system has contributed to the fragmentation and regionalization of the party system[21].

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[19] Stephen Velychenko, Russian Influence in Ukrainian Politics: A Historical Overview (Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 2021), 67-71.

[20] Taras Kuzio, Presidential Election in Ukraine 2019: Democracy Tested (London: Routledge, 2020), 89-92.

[21]Sarah Whitmore, "Parliamentary Elections in Ukraine: Navigating Complex Political Landscapes," Europe-Asia Studies 66, no. 8 (2014): 1239-1245.

Civil society:

Ukraine's civil society has emerged as a vital force in shaping the country's social, political, and economic landscape, particularly during periods of conflict and reform. It has proven to be an essential driver of democratic resilience, governance, and social cohesion[22].

Role and Characteristics of Civil Society in Ukraine:

1. Democratic Oversight and Advocacy: Civil society organizations (CSOs) play a critical role in monitoring government actions, fighting corruption, and advocating for reforms. This includes participation in anti-corruption efforts and pushing for judicial reforms. These activities often align with Ukraine's aspirations for European integration.

2. Media and Public Engagement: Civil society leverages Ukraine's diverse media landscape to influence public opinion and advocate for policies. Despite challenges, such as restricted media freedom during martial law, CSOs use platforms like the "United News Telemarathon" to maintain public unity and resilience[23].

3. International Collaboration: Ukrainian CSOs have gained significant support from international donors, enabling them to strengthen their capacity and engage in high-level governance and reform initiatives. However, this also poses challenges, such as

[22] . Orysia Lutsevych, How to Finish a Revolution: Civil Society and Democracy in Ukraine (London: Chatham House, 2013), 5-8.

[23] Mychailo Wynnyckyj, "The Role of Civil Society in the Euromaidan Movement," Ukrainian Journal of Public Policy 6, no. 3 (2015): 145-153.

creating a talent drain from public service to NGOs due to better opportunities in the civil society sector[24].

4. Community Resilience: Civil society fosters social cohesion and resilience by addressing the needs of vulnerable groups, promoting gender inclusion, and advocating for a human-centered recovery from the war. These efforts are seen as critical to Ukraine's ability to rebuild effectively post-conflict.

The pressing current issue: (The impact of the Russian-Ukrainian war on Ukrainian internal affairs)

Since the 1990s, relations between Russia and Ukraine have experienced successive crises over several issues, some of which were natural consequences of the disintegration of the former Soviet Union, while others stemmed from Ukraine's rapprochement with the West. The most prominent of these contentious issues were Ukraine's desire to join NATO, its partnership with Europe, and its ambitions regarding nuclear weapons. These tensions were exacerbated by Ukrainian measures since 2014, including economic, political, social, and even religious actions, such as the separation of the Ukrainian Orthodox Church from Russian authority. These crises ultimately led to the outbreak of the Russian-Ukrainian war in February 2022.[25]

[24] Adrian Karatnycky, "Ukraine's Orange Revolution: Causes and Consequences," Foreign Affairs 84, no. 2 (2005): 35-40.

[25] Veronica Anghel , Erik Jones , " The transatlantic relationship and the Russia_ Ukraine war " , political science Quarterly , 2024 , https://doi.org/10.1093/psquar/qqae051

The importance of studying the impact of the Russian-Ukrainian war on Ukraine's internal affairs lies in understanding the transformations that have occurred in the country as a result of this conflict. Consequently, we will examine the profound effects of the war on Ukraine's domestic politics, in addition to highlighting the social repercussions, such as the war's impact on Ukrainian national identity, as well as the economic consequences.

- **Political effects of war:**

The defining characteristic of Ukraine's domestic political scene since 1991 has been a divide among political parties promoting pro-Russia versus pro-EU/NATO foreign policy orientations, accompanied by societal splits reflecting these geopolitical lines. Until 2014 after Crimea's annexation and the war in Donbas, Russia was actively involved in influencing Ukrainian domestic politics and electoral outcomes and supporting politicians promoting a pro-Russia policy , but the Ukrainians' pro-Western geopolitical choice grew stronger following 2014 as in October 2011, EU integration was supported by 44 % of Ukrainians and economic integration with Russia by 31% , in 2021, 57 % of Ukrainians supported EU accession and only 11 % were in favor of joining a Russian-led economic union. Now the current war has united Ukrainian society as 91% of Ukrainians support joining the European Union.[26]

The Kremlin-friendly parties, lobbying for and advocating rapprochement with Russia, have always held seats in Ukraine's Parliament. However, since 2014, support

[26] Ecaterina Locoman , " What's Next For Ukraine's (and its Neighbors') Domestic and Foreign Policy " , FOREIGN POLICY RESEARCH INSTITUTE, June 2022 , https://www.fpri.org/article/2022/06/whats-next-for-ukraines-and-its-neighbors-domestic-and-foreign-policy/

shrank among Ukrainian voters for pro-Russia forces as before 2014, the Party of Regions, a pro-Russian party and previously the biggest political party in Ukraine, used to garner one-third of the votes. the pro-Russia parties traditionally garnered most of their electoral support from the eastern and southern parts of the country , but now , since the Russian army has hit the south and east the hardest with shelling and missile attacks, it is going to be problematic for pro-Russia politicians to regain the trust of Ukrainians after the war as in a recent survey showed that 98 % of Ukrainians saw Russia as a hostile country and in case some of these pro-Russia parties do come back on the political scene, the parliament is looking for mechanisms to prevent them from returning to power in post-war Ukraine and to make it harder for them to justify Russian aggression .[27]

▪ The impact of the war on Ukrainian national identity:

One of the main Russian goals of its hybrid war on Ukraine, in which it combined traditional and unconventional methods, was to suppress any sense of identity among young Ukrainians, and Russian messages over the past several decades reflect this. Russia considers Ukraine merely an artificial construct and that Ukrainianism is not in Truth is a separate language.

For its nearly three decades of independence, Ukraine has struggled to develop a unifying idea to consolidate national identity, bridge the ethnic, religious, and linguistic divisions of its heterogeneous society, and guide its geopolitical course. Although

[27] Andrew Lohsen , " How the War Could Transform Ukrainian Politics " , The Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS) , May 2022 , https://www.csis.org/analysis/how-war-could-transform-ukrainian-politics

Russia's annexation of Crimea and its undeclared proxy war in the Donetsk and Luhansk regions awakened a sense of patriotism and purpose among many Ukrainians in 2014, a substantial portion of the population continued to hope for the normalization of relations with Moscow. Proponents of this view were concentrated in the southeastern regions of the country, where local economies and supply chains were deeply integrated with Russia as a legacy of Soviet rule, and where Russia enjoyed significant social and cultural influence as a result of more than a century of immigration.[28]

Despite that the hybrid war that was triggered by the Russian federation which generated serious problems for Ukraine but it succeeded to adapt and fight against the hybrid threats as the results of the research presented in the article of " Patrotism of the Young Generation in Ukraine in the Era of Hybrid War " showed that many ukrainian young people felt patriotic (about 67%) and were proud of their country (over 78%). Therefore, despite the ongoing hybrid war and attacks on the sense of national pride, this didn't break the spirits of the Ukrainians as they emphasized that the conflict in the east helped them understand that it didn't matter what language you used or from which region you were because all people in this challenging time are Ukrainians.[29]

Economic effects of the war on Ukraine: ▪

[28] Jan Courter , " Russian Preinvasion Influence Activities in the War with Ukraine " , Military Review , volume (1) , Issue (7) , 2022, p.p 16- 27

[29] Mateusz Kamionka , " Patrotism of the Young Generation in Ukraine in the Era of Hybrid War " , LITHUANIA ANNUAL STRATEGIC REVIEW , volume (18) , Issue (1) , 2022 , p.p 221-239

Ukraine's economy has been severely damaged by the war that has been going on since February 2022, as millions of residents fled, cities and towns were destroyed and bombed, logistics and supply routes were disrupted, and the infrastructure and energy sectors were damaged, and the gross domestic product fell by 29.1 percent in 2022, in the largest annual decline. His since the independence of Ukraine since 1991, In addition, the high rate of corruption in Ukraine - which the Ukrainians themselves admit - affects the performance of the Ukrainian economy, which now depends on American and European subsidies .[30]

With the frontlines stabilizing and improving air defences of Ukrainian cities, economic activity began to revive and this was particularly true in the western parts of the country, bolstered by the influx of displaced people and Ukraine's economy returned to positive growth in late 2022. On the other hand, the Stabilization of the conflict in the east and south also fuelled domestic demand as many who had fled the country at the start of the war could return. The output of industries that support the war effort also increased significantly, and access to international financing eased. Ukraine managed to push the Russian navy away from its territorial waters, making it possible to raise the volume of grain shipped via the Black Sea close to pre-invasion levels.[31]

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[30] World Bank, " Local and Global Economic Impacts of the War in Ukraine, December 2022 , https://www.worldbank.org/en/events/2022/12/06/local-and-global-economic-impacts-of-the-war-in-ukraine

[31] Likka Korhonen , "Ukraine's economy grows amidst the rising toll of war " , Bank of Finland Bulletin Articals on the Economy , February 2024 , https://www.bofbulletin.fi/en/blogs/2024/ukraines-economy-grows-amidst-the-rising-toll-of-war/

Therefore, we can conclude from this that the Ukrainian economy did not suffer from an economic collapse as a result of the war, but rather from severe economic crises from which it is struggling to recover, with Western assistance, specifically from the United States of America .

Conclusion:

In conclusion, the political institutions in Ukraine reflect the nature of the semi-presidential system that balances executive, legislative and judicial powers, where the president plays an essential role in maintaining sovereignty and the constitutional order. The Council of Ministers is an executive body with a limited role under the control of the president, while the Constitutional Court ensures adherence to the constitution and resolves political disputes. The Verkhovna Rada represents the backbone of legislative power. The electoral system relied on mixed representation, which contributed to the division of parties regionally, while civil society played a prominent role in supporting democracy and confronting humanitarian crises.

Ukraine witnessed major historical developments that affected its national and cultural identity, specifically during the period of the Russian Empire and the Soviet Union. The country faced great challenges represented by internal divisions between pro-Russian and pro-Western trends.

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